Mathematical Language

Notation and Conventions

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About This Document

Mathematical Language records the notation and writing conventions adopted here. It is guided by deliberate personal preferences together with established mathematical practice; when no personal convention has been fixed, standard mathematical usage is the default.

Part I establishes general notation and writing conventions; Part II records subject-specific notation and conventions.

This document is non-exhaustive. Alternative notations are listed in preferred order: the first is used by default, while later forms remain acceptable when context or established usage favors them. Unlisted notation is not necessarily invalid.

Part I. General Conventions and Writing

1 General Notation and Conventions

Prefer parentheses for ordinary grouping when delimiters are interchangeable, including in nested expressions. Use other delimiters when established mathematical notation calls for them. Use the adopted standard arrow forms and the usual sizes of delimiters and separators by default. Adjust their lengths or sizes only when there is a clear mathematical or typographical reason.

In LaTeX mathematical source, put one source-space after punctuation commas. TeX determines the typeset spacing; retain explicit spacing commands only where typographically appropriate.

Item	Convention
Scalars	Ordinary mathematical italic letters, for example a, b, c, λ, t.
Variables and Labels	Use mathematical italic for variables and indices, and upright Roman type for descriptive labels and abbreviations, unless established mathematical notation calls for otherwise.
Vectors and Matrices	Vectors and matrices are written in bold, typically with lowercase and uppercase letters, respectively. Greek symbols are also bold when used for vectors or matrices. Vectors are columns by default; established field-specific conventions are respected.
Matrix Delimiters	Parentheses are preferred; square brackets are a standard alternative.
Dimension Subscripts	Use dimension subscripts when informative; omit them when the dimension is clear or irrelevant
Number Systems	Blackboard-bold letters, such as $\mathbb{N}, \mathbb{Z}, \mathbb{Q}, \mathbb{R}, \mathbb{C}$
Fields	Arbitrary fields are typically denoted by italic uppercase letters such as F, K, L. Established blackboard-bold notation, such as $\mathbb{F}$ and $\mathbb{F}_q$, is also used where appropriate.
Sets	Ordinary uppercase letters such as A, B, X, Y, unless a field-specific convention requires otherwise.
Families and Collections	Calligraphic letters, such as $\mathcal{F}$; script letters, such as $\mathscr{A}$, represent distinct notation
Symbol Distinctions	Different mathematical letterforms are treated as distinct symbols, such as A, $\mathbf{A}$, $\mathcal{A}$, $\mathscr{A}$, $\mathbb{A}$, ϵ, ε, ϕ, and φ.
Named Operators	Upright Roman type, for example det, ker, im, rk, and tr.
Large Operators	Use display-style large operators and conventional index placement; use compact forms only when the layout requires them

Notation	Meaning
$(a_1, \ldots, a_n)$	Ordered tuple

Notation	Meaning
$(a_n),\ \{a_n\}$	Sequence
$(a_i)_{i\in I},\ \{a_i\}_{i\in I}$	Indexed family over I
(a, b)	Open interval
$[a, b]$	Closed interval
$[a, b)$	Left-closed, right-open interval
$(a, b]$	Left-open, right-closed interval
$\{a_1, \ldots, a_n\}$	Set delimiters
$\{x \in A \mid P(x)\}$, $\{x \in A\colon P(x)\}$	Set-builder notation
$\langle x, y\rangle$	Pairing or inner product, according to context
$\lvert x\rvert$	Absolute value, modulus, cardinality, or order, according to context
$\lVert x\rVert$	Norm
$a = b$	Equality
$a \coloneqq b$	a is defined to be b.
$a \equiv b$	Identity, equivalence, or congruence, according to context
$a \cong b$	Isomorphism or congruence, according to context
$a \approx b$	Approximation
$f\colon X \to Y$	Function or map from X to Y
$x \mapsto f(x)$	Elementwise rule of a map
$f\colon X \to Y,\ x \mapsto f(x)$	Function with domain, codomain, and mapping rule
$g \circ f$	Composition: first f, then g
$f^{\circ n}$	n-fold composition of a self-map f
$f\lvert_A,\ f \restriction_A$	Restriction of f to A
id_X	Identity map on X

2 Mathematical Writing

Mathematical Environments.

Item	Convention
Definition	Precise meaning of a term, object, property, or construction.
Notation	Introduction or declaration of mathematical notation.
Convention	Standing choice of notation, terminology, normalization, or usage for the stated context.
Axiom	Fundamental statement accepted without proof as part of a mathematical system.
Assumption	Premise adopted for the current statement, argument, construction, or discussion.
Hypothesis	Condition under which a result or theory is considered; traditionally named hypotheses retain their established terminology.
Conjecture	Statement proposed to be true but not proved in full generality.
Theorem	Principal mathematical result.
Proposition	Mathematical result of more limited scope or emphasis.
Lemma	Supporting result, usually used in another proof.
Corollary	Result following readily from a preceding result.
Claim	Local or intermediate assertion within a larger argument.
Fact	Established mathematical statement presented without the emphasis of a named result.

Item	Convention
Observation	Mathematical feature or consequence readily recognized from the current context.
Proof	Rigorous argument establishing a mathematical assertion.
Sketch	Outline of the essential reasoning in a proof, construction, or solution, with some details omitted.
Formula	Distinguished mathematical identity or closed-form expression.
Algorithm	Explicit step-by-step procedure for carrying out a mathematical or computational task.
Construction	Specification of how a mathematical object is defined or built to meet stated requirements.
Design	Explanation of component roles and the rationale behind structural choices in a mathematical object, function, method, or environment.
Example	Concrete instance illustrating a definition, concept, method, or result.
Counterexample	Example disproving an assertion or showing that a condition is necessary.
Application	Use of a mathematical concept, method, or result in a specific mathematical or applied setting.
Recall	Reminder of previously introduced or assumed-known mathematical material relevant to the current discussion.
Motivation	Explanation of why a concept, method, problem, or development is introduced or worth considering.
Intuition	Informal insight suggesting what to expect or why a mathematical statement or method seems plausible, without constituting a proof.
Remark	Supplementary mathematical clarification, qualification, or extension of the surrounding material.
Note	Brief contextual or practical information, such as a usage instruction or permission.
Comment	Retrospective interpretation or takeaway concerning the preceding material.
Warning	Important notice of a subtlety, common error, or potentially misleading point.
Question	Question raised for thought, exploration, or discussion without necessarily requiring a complete solution.
Problem	Mathematical task intended to be solved.
Exercise	Task primarily intended to practice, apply, or reinforce mathematical material.
Open Problem	Problem not known to be solved in its stated form.
Hint	Partial clue intended to guide the reader toward a proof or solution without giving the complete argument or answer.
Suggestion	Optional recommendation to consider a particular observation, method, or approach.
Idea	Key insight guiding a proof, solution, or construction.
Strategy	Broad plan for approaching a problem, proof, or construction.
Tactic	Local step within a larger strategy.
Solution	Resolution of a stated problem or task by proof, computation, construction, or other appropriate means.

Proof, sketch, and solution labels are written as *Proof*, *Sketch*, and *Solution*, respectively, each followed by a period.

Notation	Meaning
□	Ending for ordinary proofs and solutions
■	Ending for substantial, difficult, or particularly important proofs
Q.E.D.	Ending for exceptionally difficult, significant, or paper-level proofs

Enumeration and Subdivision. Enumeration labels are set in upright Roman type. Their form is determined by structural role rather than nesting depth.

Item	Convention
1.1, 1.2, 1.3, ...	Independent child problems or standalone units under a common parent; each is a distinct subproblem that may be stated, solved, and referenced separately.
(1), (2), (3), ...	Ordinary parallel enumeration, such as choices, cases, possibilities, alternatives, examples, or procedural steps; not a subdivision of a single problem or a clause of a formal mathematical statement.
(a), (b), (c), ...	Connected subparts of a single problem or task that share a common statement, setup, or context.
(i), (ii), (iii), ...	Formal mathematical clauses within definitions, theorems, propositions, lemmas, and related statements, such as hypotheses, conditions, properties, conclusions, or equivalent statements.

Mathematical Shorthand.

Typeset abbreviations may be used in mathematical writing when appropriate; handwritten shorthand is reserved for personal notes, scratch work, and blackboard writing.

Typeset Abbreviations.

Notation	Meaning
i.e.	that is
e.g.	for example
etc.	and so on
cf.	compare
resp.	respectively
vs.	versus
i.o.w.	in other words
s.t.	such that
iff	if and only if
w.r.t.	with respect to
const	constant
a.e.	almost everywhere
a.s.	almost surely
i.i.d.	independent and identically distributed
N.t.	Note that
w.l.o.g.	without loss of generality
w.t.s.	want to show (that)
e.t.s.	enough to show (that)
t.f.a.e.	the following are equivalent
i.t.s.w.	in the same way
o.t.o.h.	on the other hand
LHS	Left-hand side

Notation	Meaning
RHS	Right-hand side
IVT	Intermediate Value Theorem
EVT	Extreme Value Theorem
MVT	Mean Value Theorem
FTC	Fundamental Theorem of Calculus
ODE	Ordinary Differential Equation
PDE	Partial Differential Equation
IVP	Initial Value Problem
BVP	Boundary Value Problem

Handwritten Shorthand.

Notation	Meaning
Def	Definition
Thm	Theorem
Prop	Proposition
Lem	Lemma
Cor	Corollary
Pf	Proof
Sol	Solution
Ex	Example
Exer	Exercise
Rmk	Remark
Sps	Suppose (that)
cont	continuous
cont.ly	continuously
difb	differentiable
difb.ly	differentiably
difl	differential
bdd	bounded
unif	uniform
unif.ly	uniformly
lin	linear
lin.ly	linearly
dep	dependent
indep	independent
approx	approximate
triv	trivial
fnc	function
seq	sequence
eqn	equation
eqlt	equality
ineqlt	inequality
sys	system
comb	combination
vec	vector
mat	matrix

Notation	Meaning
col	column
pt	point
bdy	boundary
nbhd	neighborhood
itvl	interval
op	operation
num	number
val	value
elmt	element
cw	clockwise
ccw	counterclockwise
w/	with
w/o	without

Mathematical Phrases.

Phrase	Use
We find by inspection that ...	Used when a conclusion follows directly from inspection.

Part II. Notation by Subject

3 Set Theory and Logic

Notation	Meaning
$\mathbb{N} = \{1, 2, 3, \dots\},\ \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 1},\ \mathbb{Z}^+$	Positive integers
$\mathbb{N}_0 = \{0, 1, 2, 3, \dots\},\ \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$	Nonnegative integers
$\mathbb{Z}$	Integers
$\mathbb{Q}$	Rational numbers
$\mathbb{R}$	Real numbers
$\mathbb{C}$	Complex numbers
$\varnothing,\ \emptyset$	Empty set
$x \in A$	x is an element of A.
$x \notin A$	x is not an element of A.
$A \subseteq B$	A is a subset of B; equality is allowed.
$A \subsetneq B$	A is a proper subset of B.
$A \supseteq B$	A is a superset of B; equality is allowed.
$A \supsetneq B$	A is a proper superset of B.
$A \cup B$	Union
$A \cap B$	Intersection
$(A_i)_{i \in I}$	Indexed family of sets
$\bigcup_{i \in I} A_i$	Union of an indexed family of sets
$\bigcap_{i \in I} A_i$	Intersection of an indexed family of sets
$\limsup_{n \to \infty} A_n$	Set-theoretic limit superior of (A_n)

Notation	Meaning
$\liminf_{n\to\infty} A_n$	Set-theoretic limit inferior of (A_n)
$A \setminus B,\ A - B$	Set difference
$A \triangle B,\ A \,\Delta\, B$	Symmetric difference
A^{c}	Complement of A in the ambient set
$\mathcal{P}(A),\ 2^A$	Power set
$A \times B$	Cartesian product
$A_1 \times \cdots \times A_n,\ A^n$	Finite Cartesian product; A^n is the n-fold Cartesian power of A
$\prod_{i\in I} A_i$	Cartesian product of an indexed family of sets
$A \sqcup B,\ A \dot\cup B$	Disjoint union
$\bigsqcup_{i\in I} A_i$	Disjoint union of an indexed family of sets
$A \cap B = \varnothing$	A and B are disjoint.
$\lvert A\rvert,\ \#A$	Cardinality
$\aleph_0$	Cardinality of a countably infinite set
$\mathfrak{c}$	Cardinality of the continuum
$R \subseteq X \times Y$	Binary relation between X and Y
xRy	x is related to y by the relation R.
R^{-1}	Inverse relation of R
$x \sim y$	Equivalent elements under an understood equivalence relation
$[x]_R,\ [x]$	Equivalence class of x under R
$A/\!\sim$	Set of equivalence classes
$\operatorname{dom} f$	Domain of f
$\operatorname{codom} f$	Codomain of f
$f(A)$	Image of A under f
$f^{-1}(B)$	Preimage of B under f
$\operatorname{im} f$	Image of the map f
Y^X	Set of all functions from X to Y
$f^{-1}\colon Y \to X$	Inverse function of a bijection $f\colon X \to Y$
$f\colon X \hookrightarrow Y$	Injective map
$f\colon X \twoheadrightarrow Y$	Surjective map
$f\colon X \rightarrowtail Y$	Bijective map
$f\colon X \xrightarrow{\sim} Y$	Isomorphism; for sets, equivalently a bijection
$\mathbb{1}_A(x)$	Indicator function of A
$\forall x \in A$	For every $x \in A$
$\exists x \in A$	There exists $x \in A$.
$\exists! x \in A$	There exists a unique $x \in A$.
$\nexists x \in A$	There does not exist $x \in A$.
$P \Rightarrow Q$	P implies Q in ordinary mathematical writing.
$P \Leftarrow Q$	Q implies P in ordinary mathematical writing.
$P \not\Rightarrow Q$	P does not imply Q.
$P \Leftrightarrow Q$	P if and only if Q in ordinary mathematical writing.
$P \wedge Q$	Logical conjunction
$P \vee Q$	Logical disjunction
$\neg P$	Logical negation
$\top,\ \bot$	Truth and falsehood constants, respectively, in formal logic
$\varphi \to \psi,\ \varphi \leftrightarrow \psi$	Conditional and biconditional connectives in formal logic

Notation	Meaning
$\mathcal{M} \models \varphi,\ \mathcal{M} \not\models \varphi$	$\mathcal{M}$ satisfies, or does not satisfy, the formula φ.
$\Gamma \models \varphi,\ \Gamma \not\models \varphi$	φ is, or is not, a semantic consequence of Γ.
$\Gamma \vdash \varphi,\ \Gamma \nvdash \varphi$	φ is, or is not, syntactically derivable from Γ.
$\lightning$	Contradiction reached in a proof or argument; distinct from the formal falsehood constant $\bot$
$\therefore$	Therefore
$\because$	Because

4 Calculus and Analysis

The differential d is upright; ε is the default small positive quantity in analysis.

Notation	Meaning
$\lim_{x\to a} f(x),\ f(a^{\pm})$	Two-sided limit at a; $f(a^{\pm})$ is used only for a finite limit
$\lim_{x\to a^-} f(x),\ f(a^-)$	Left-hand limit at a
$\lim_{x\to a^+} f(x),\ f(a^+)$	Right-hand limit at a
$\lim_{x\to\infty} f(x),\ f(\infty)$	Limit as $x \to \infty$; $f(\infty)$ is used only for a finite limit
$\lim_{x\to-\infty} f(x),\ f(-\infty)$	Limit as $x \to -\infty$; $f(-\infty)$ is used only for a finite limit
$\lim_{x\to a} f(x) = \pm\infty$	Infinite limit at a
$\min A$	Minimum of A
$\max A$	Maximum of A
$\inf A$	Infimum of A
$\sup A$	Supremum of A
$\arg\min_{x\in A} f(x)$	Set of minimizers of f over A
$\arg\max_{x\in A} f(x)$	Set of maximizers of f over A
$\overline{\mathbb{R}} = \mathbb{R} \cup \{-\infty, +\infty\}$	Extended real line
$\lim_{n\to\infty} x_n = x,\ x_n \to x$	Convergence of a sequence
(x_{n_k})	Subsequence of the sequence (x_n)
$a_n \nearrow L$	Monotone increasing convergence to L
$a_n \searrow L$	Monotone decreasing convergence to L
$\limsup_{n\to\infty} a_n$	Limit superior of the sequence (a_n)
$\liminf_{n\to\infty} a_n$	Limit inferior of the sequence (a_n)
$f(x) \sim g(x)$	Asymptotic equivalence in the stated limiting regime, typically meaning $f(x)/g(x) \to 1$
$f_n \to f,\ f_n \xrightarrow{\text{ptw}} f$	Pointwise convergence of f_n to f
$f_n \rightrightarrows f,\ f_n \xrightarrow{\text{unif}} f$	Uniform convergence
$f_n \xrightarrow{\text{a.e.}} f$	Convergence almost everywhere
$f'(a)$	First derivative of f at a
$f^{(n)}(a)$	nth derivative of f at a
$\dfrac{\mathrm{d}y}{\mathrm{d}x}$	Derivative of y with respect to x
$\dfrac{\mathrm{d}^n y}{\mathrm{d}x^n}$	nth derivative of y with respect to x in Leibniz notation
$\dfrac{\partial f}{\partial x_i},\ \partial_i f,\ f_{x_i}$	Partial derivative with respect to x_i

Notation	Meaning
$\frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x_j \partial x_i},\ \partial_{ji} f,\ f_{x_i x_j}$	Mixed partial derivative, first with respect to x_i and then x_j
$D_{\mathbf{v}} f(\mathbf{a}),\ \partial_{\mathbf{v}} f(\mathbf{a})$	Directional derivative of f at $\mathbf{a}$ along $\mathbf{v}$
$\mathrm{d}f = \sum_{i=1}^{n} \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_i}\,\mathrm{d}x_i$	Total differential of a scalar function of n variables
$\alpha = (\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) \in \mathbb{N}_0^n$	Multi-index
$\lvert\alpha\rvert,\ \alpha!$	Order $\lvert\alpha\rvert = \alpha_1 + \cdots + \alpha_n$ and factorial $\alpha! = \alpha_1! \cdots \alpha_n!$ of a multi-index
$\mathbf{x}^\alpha = x_1^{\alpha_1} \cdots x_n^{\alpha_n}$	Multi-index monomial for $\mathbf{x} = (x_1, \ldots, x_n)$
$D^\alpha f,\ \partial^\alpha f$	Mixed partial derivative specified by the multi-index α
$\mathbf{J_F}(\mathbf{a}),\ D\mathbf{F}(\mathbf{a})$	Jacobian matrix of $\mathbf{F}$ at $\mathbf{a}$
$\det \mathbf{J_F}(\mathbf{a}),\ \det D\mathbf{F}(\mathbf{a})$	Jacobian determinant of $\mathbf{F}$ at $\mathbf{a}$
$\operatorname{Hess} f$	Hessian matrix of f
$\nabla f,\ \operatorname{grad} f$	Gradient of f
$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{F},\ \operatorname{div} \mathbf{F}$	Divergence of $\mathbf{F}$
$\nabla \times \mathbf{F},\ \operatorname{curl} \mathbf{F}$	Curl of $\mathbf{F}$
Δf	Laplacian of f
$\int f(x)\,\mathrm{d}x$	Indefinite integral of f
$\int_a^b f(x)\,\mathrm{d}x$	Definite integral over $[a, b]$
$F(x)\vert_a^b,\ [F(x)]_a^b$	Evaluation at the endpoints: $F(b) - F(a)$
$\int_a^\infty f(x)\,\mathrm{d}x,\ \int_{-\infty}^b f(x)\,\mathrm{d}x$	Improper integrals over unbounded intervals
$\int_a^b f\,\mathrm{d}\alpha$	Riemann–Stieltjes integral of f over $[a, b]$ with respect to α
$P = \{x_0, \ldots, x_n\}$	Partition of $[a, b]$, with $a = x_0 < \cdots < x_n = b$
$\sum_{i=1}^{n} f(\xi_i)\Delta x_i$	Tagged Riemann sum with sample points ξ_i and subinterval widths Δx_i
$\iint_D f\,\mathrm{d}A$	Double integral over D
$\iiint_\Omega f\,\mathrm{d}V$	Triple integral over Ω
$\mathbf{r}(t)$	Parametrized curve
$\mathrm{d}s$	Element of arc length
$\int_C f\,\mathrm{d}s$	Scalar line integral along C with respect to arc length
$\int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot \mathrm{d}\mathbf{r}$	Line integral of the vector field $\mathbf{F}$ along C
$\iint_S f\,\mathrm{d}S$	Scalar surface integral over S
$\oiint_S$	Surface integral over a closed surface S
$\iint_S \mathbf{F} \cdot \mathbf{n}\,\mathrm{d}S$	Flux integral through S
$\int_C f(z)\,\mathrm{d}z$	Complex line integral along C
$\oint_C$	Integral along a closed curve C
$\operatorname{Ind}(\gamma, z)$	Winding number of the closed curve γ about z
$-C$	The contour C with the opposite orientation
γ^{-1}	Reversed parametrized path γ

Notation	Meaning
PV, P.V.	Principal value (in particular, Cauchy principal value)
$\sum_{k=1}^{n} a_k$	Finite sum
$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} a_k$	Infinite series
$\prod_{k=1}^{n} a_k$	Finite product
$\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n(x-a)^n$	Power series centered at a
$\sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} a_n(z-z_0)^n$	Laurent series centered at z_0
$\sum_{k=0}^{n} \frac{f^{(k)}(a)}{k!}(x-a)^k$	nth Taylor polynomial of f about a
$\widehat{f}(n)$	nth complex Fourier coefficient: $\widehat{f}(n) = \frac{1}{2\pi}\int_{-\pi}^{\pi} f(x)e^{-inx}\,\mathrm{d}x$
$S_N f$	Nth symmetric Fourier partial sum: $S_N f(x) = \sum_{n=-N}^{N} \widehat{f}(n)e^{inx}$
$\sigma_N f$	Nth Fejèr mean: $\sigma_N f(x) = \frac{1}{N+1}\sum_{k=0}^{N} S_k f(x)$
e^x, $\exp x$	Exponential function
$\ln x$, $\log_e x$	Natural logarithm of a positive real number
$\lg x$, $\log_{10} x$	Logarithm to base 10
$\mathrm{lb}\, x$, $\log_2 x$	Logarithm to base 2
$\log_a x$	Logarithm to base a
$W_k(z)$	kth branch of the Lambert W-function; W_0 is the principal branch
$\sin x$	Sine
$\cos x$	Cosine
$\tan x$	Tangent
$\csc x$	Cosecant
$\sec x$	Secant
$\cot x$	Cotangent
$\arcsin x$, $\sin^{-1} x$	Principal inverse sine, $[-1,1] \to [-\pi/2, \pi/2]$
$\arccos x$, $\cos^{-1} x$	Principal inverse cosine, $[-1,1] \to [0, \pi]$
$\arctan x$, $\tan^{-1} x$	Principal inverse tangent, $\mathbb{R} \to (-\pi/2, \pi/2)$
$\mathrm{arccsc}\, x$, $\csc^{-1} x$	Principal inverse cosecant with range $[-\pi/2, 0) \cup (0, \pi/2]$
$\mathrm{arcsec}\, x$, $\sec^{-1} x$	Principal inverse secant with range $[0, \pi/2) \cup (\pi/2, \pi]$
$\mathrm{arccot}\, x$, $\cot^{-1} x$	Principal real inverse cotangent, $\mathbb{R} \to (0, \pi)$
$\sinh x$	Hyperbolic sine
$\cosh x$	Hyperbolic cosine
$\tanh x$	Hyperbolic tangent
$\mathrm{csch}\, x$	Hyperbolic cosecant
$\mathrm{sech}\, x$	Hyperbolic secant
$\coth x$	Hyperbolic cotangent
$\mathrm{arcsinh}\, x$, $\sinh^{-1} x$	Principal real inverse hyperbolic sine, $\mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{R}$
$\mathrm{arccosh}\, x$, $\cosh^{-1} x$	Principal real inverse hyperbolic cosine, $[1, \infty) \to [0, \infty)$
$\mathrm{arctanh}\, x$, $\tanh^{-1} x$	Principal real inverse hyperbolic tangent, $(-1, 1) \to \mathbb{R}$

Notation	Meaning
$\operatorname{arccsch} x,\ \operatorname{csch}^{-1} x$	Principal inverse hyperbolic cosecant
$\operatorname{arcsech} x,\ \operatorname{sech}^{-1} x$	Principal inverse hyperbolic secant
$\operatorname{arccoth} x,\ \coth^{-1} x$	Principal inverse hyperbolic cotangent
$\Gamma(z)$	Gamma function
$\psi(z)$	Digamma function, $\psi(z) = \Gamma'(z)/\Gamma(z)$
$B(x, y)$	Beta function
γ	Euler–Mascheroni constant
$\zeta(s)$	Riemann zeta function
$(X, \mathcal{A}, \mu)$	Measure space X with σ-algebra $\mathcal{A}$ and measure μ
$\mathcal{A}$	σ-algebra of measurable subsets of X, when the underlying set is understood
$\mathcal{B}(X)$	Borel σ-algebra of a topological space X
$\mu(E)$	Measure of a measurable set $E \in \mathcal{A}$
$\int_E f \, \mathrm{d}\mu$	Integral of f over E with respect to the measure μ
$f = g$ a.e., $\quad f = g$ μ-a.e.	Equality almost everywhere, with the measure omitted when understood
$\operatorname{ess\,sup}_{x \in E} f(x)$	Essential supremum of f on E
$\operatorname{ess\,inf}_{x \in E} f(x)$	Essential infimum of f on E
$C(\Omega),\ C^0(\Omega)$	Continuous functions on Ω
$C^k(\Omega)$	k times continuously differentiable functions on Ω
$C^\infty(\Omega)$	Smooth functions on Ω
$C_b(X)$	Bounded continuous scalar-valued functions on X
$\operatorname{supp} f$	Support of f
$C_c(\Omega),\ C_c^\infty(\Omega)$	Continuous and smooth functions on Ω with compact support, respectively
$V_a^b(f)$	Total variation of f on $[a, b]$
$\mathrm{BV}([a, b])$	Functions of bounded variation on $[a, b]$
$\mathcal{R}([a, b])$	Functions Riemann integrable on $[a, b]$
$\mathcal{R}([a, b], \alpha)$	Functions Riemann–Stieltjes integrable on $[a, b]$ with respect to α
$L^p(\Omega),\ L^p(X, \mu)$	Lebesgue L^p spaces on Ω or (X, μ), modulo almost-everywhere equality
$L^\infty(\Omega),\ L^\infty(X, \mu)$	Essentially bounded measurable functions on Ω or (X, μ), modulo almost-everywhere equality
ℓ^p	Space of p-summable scalar sequences
ℓ^∞	Space of bounded scalar sequences
$\|f\|_\infty$	Supremum norm of a bounded scalar-valued function f
$\|f\|_{L^p(X,\mu)}$	L^p-norm of f on X with respect to μ
$\|f\|_{L^p(\Omega)},\ \|f\|_p$	L^p-norm of f on Ω
$\|f\|_{L^\infty(\Omega)}$	Essential supremum norm of f on Ω
$B_r(x)$	Open ball of radius r centered at x
$\overline{B}_r(x) = \{y \mid d(x, y) \le r\}$	Closed ball of radius r centered at x; not necessarily the closure of $B_r(x)$
$\widehat{\mathbb{C}} = \mathbb{C} \cup \{\infty\}$	Extended complex plane, equivalently the Riemann sphere
$i^2 = -1$	Imaginary unit
$z = x + iy$	Complex number with real part x and imaginary part y
$\operatorname{Re} z,\ \Re z$	Real part of z
$\operatorname{Im} z,\ \Im z$	Imaginary part of z; distinct from lowercase im for image

Notation	Meaning
$\overline{z}$	Complex conjugate
$\lvert z\rvert$	Complex modulus
$\arg z$	Argument of a nonzero complex number z; its values differ by integer multiples of 2π
$\operatorname{Arg} z$	Principal argument of $z \neq 0$, with $-\pi < \operatorname{Arg} z \leq \pi$
$\log z,\ \ln z$	General multivalued complex logarithm for $z \neq 0$; $\log z = \{\ln\lvert z\rvert + i(\operatorname{Arg} z + 2\pi k) \mid k \in \mathbb{Z}\}$
$\operatorname{Log} z,\ \operatorname{Ln} z$	Principal complex logarithm for $z \neq 0$; $\operatorname{Log} z = \ln\lvert z\rvert + i \operatorname{Arg} z$. On $\mathbb{C} \setminus (-\infty, 0]$, it is the analytic principal branch, with $-\pi < \operatorname{Arg} z < \pi$
$\mathcal{O}(U)$	Holomorphic functions on an open set $U \subseteq \mathbb{C}$
$\operatorname{Res}(f; a),\ \operatorname{Res}_{z=a} f(z)$	Residue of f at a finite point a
$\operatorname{Res}(f; \infty),\ \operatorname{Res}_{z=\infty} f(z)$	Residue of f at infinity

5 Linear Algebra

Notation	Meaning
$M_{m\times n}(F),\ F^{m\times n}$	Space of $m \times n$ matrices over the field F
$M_n(F)$	Space (and matrix algebra) of $n \times n$ matrices over F
$\mathbf{A} = (a_{ij}),\ \mathbf{A} = [a_{ij}]$	Matrix with (i, j)-entry a_{ij}
$\mathbf{A}^{\mathrm{T}}$	Transpose of $\mathbf{A}$
$\mathbf{A}^{\mathrm{H}}$	Conjugate transpose of $\mathbf{A}$
$\mathbf{A}^{-1}$	Inverse of $\mathbf{A}$
$\mathbf{I}_n,\ \mathbf{I}$	Identity matrix
$\mathbf{0}$	Zero vector or zero matrix, with dimension understood
$\mathbf{e}_i$	ith standard basis vector
$\mathbf{i},\ \mathbf{j},\ \mathbf{k}$	Standard basis vectors of $\mathbb{R}^3$, along the x-, y-, and z-axes, respectively
$\mathbf{1}$	All-ones vector
$\mathbf{D}$	Diagonal matrix
$\operatorname{diag}(d_1, \ldots, d_n)$	Diagonal matrix with entries $d_1, \ldots, d_n$
$\mathbf{P}$	Projection matrix
$\det(\mathbf{A}),\ \lvert\mathbf{A}\rvert$	Determinant
$\operatorname{rk}(\mathbf{A}),\ \operatorname{rank}(\mathbf{A})$	Rank
$\operatorname{tr}(\mathbf{A}),\ \operatorname{trace}(\mathbf{A})$	Trace
$\operatorname{adj}(\mathbf{A})$	Adjugate matrix
M_{ij}	Minor of the (i, j)-entry
$C_{ij} = (-1)^{i+j} M_{ij}$	Cofactor of the (i, j)-entry
$\mathbf{A} \otimes \mathbf{B}$	Kronecker product of matrices $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$
$\operatorname{Col}(\mathbf{A})$	Column space
$\operatorname{Row}(\mathbf{A})$	Row space
$\ker \mathbf{A},\ \operatorname{Null}(\mathbf{A})$	Null space of $\mathbf{A}$
V, W	Vector spaces, usually over an understood field F
$\operatorname{Hom}_F(V, W)$	Vector space of F-linear maps from V to W
$\operatorname{End}_F(V)$	F-algebra of F-linear endomorphisms of V
$\mathcal{L}(X, Y)$	Bounded linear maps between normed spaces X and Y
$\dim V$	Dimension of V

Notation	Meaning
$\operatorname{span}(\mathbf{v}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{v}_k)$	Span of the listed vectors
$U \oplus V$	Direct sum
V/U	Quotient vector space of V by its vector subspace $U \subseteq V$; elements are cosets $\mathbf{v} + U$
$\ker T$	Kernel of a linear map T
$\operatorname{nullity}(T) = \dim \ker T$	Nullity of a linear map T
$\operatorname{im} T$	Image of a linear map T
$\mathcal{B} = (\mathbf{b}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{b}_n)$	Ordered basis
$[\mathbf{v}]_{\mathcal{B}}$	Coordinate vector of $\mathbf{v}$ with respect to the ordered basis $\mathcal{B}$
$[T]_{\mathcal{C} \leftarrow \mathcal{B}}$	Matrix of $T\colon V \to W$ relative to domain basis $\mathcal{B}$ and codomain basis $\mathcal{C}$
$[T]_{\mathcal{B}}$	Matrix of an endomorphism $T\colon V \to V$ when the same basis $\mathcal{B}$ is used in the domain and codomain
$\mathbf{P}_{\mathcal{C} \leftarrow \mathcal{B}}$	Change-of-coordinate matrix from basis $\mathcal{B}$ to basis $\mathcal{C}$
V^*	Algebraic dual of a vector space V; for a normed space X, X^* usually denotes the continuous dual
$\langle \mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v} \rangle,\ (\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v})$	Inner product. Over complex spaces, the inner product is conjugate-linear in the first argument and linear in the second
$\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{v},\ \mathbf{u}^{\mathrm{T}}\mathbf{v}$	Standard Euclidean inner product on $\mathbb{R}^n$
$\mathbf{u}^{\mathrm{H}}\mathbf{v}$	Standard Hermitian inner product on $\mathbb{C}^n$
$\lVert \mathbf{v} \rVert$	Norm of $\mathbf{v}$
$\lVert \mathbf{x} \rVert_p$	Vector p-norm, for $1 \leq p < \infty$
$\lVert \mathbf{x} \rVert_\infty$	Vector infinity norm
$\lVert T \rVert_{\mathrm{op}}$	Operator norm $\sup_{\lVert x \rVert \leq 1} \lVert Tx \rVert$ of a bounded linear map $T\colon X \to Y$
$\lVert \mathbf{A} \rVert_{\mathrm{F}}$	Frobenius norm of $\mathbf{A}$
$\mathbf{u} \perp \mathbf{v}$	Orthogonality
$U^\perp$	Orthogonal complement of the subspace U
$\operatorname{proj}_U \mathbf{x}$	Orthogonal projection of $\mathbf{x}$ onto the subspace U
$\operatorname{proj}_{\mathbf{v}} \mathbf{x}$	Orthogonal projection of $\mathbf{x}$ onto $\operatorname{span}(\mathbf{v})$
$\mathbf{u} \times \mathbf{v}$	Cross product in $\mathbb{R}^3$
$\mathbf{A}^{\mathrm{T}} = \mathbf{A}$	Real symmetric matrix
$\mathbf{A}^{\mathrm{T}} = -\mathbf{A}$	Real skew-symmetric matrix
$\mathbf{A}^{\mathrm{H}} = \mathbf{A}$	Hermitian matrix
$\mathbf{A}^{\mathrm{H}} = -\mathbf{A}$	Skew-Hermitian matrix
$\mathbf{Q}^{\mathrm{T}}\mathbf{Q} = \mathbf{I}$	Real orthogonal matrix $\mathbf{Q}$
$\mathbf{U}^{\mathrm{H}}\mathbf{U} = \mathbf{I}$	Unitary matrix $\mathbf{U}$
$\mathbf{A}\mathbf{A}^{\mathrm{H}} = \mathbf{A}^{\mathrm{H}}\mathbf{A}$	Normal matrix
$\mathbf{P}^2 = \mathbf{P}$	Projection matrix
$\mathbf{P}^2 = \mathbf{P} = \mathbf{P}^{\mathrm{T}}$	Orthogonal projection matrix over $\mathbb{R}$
$\mathbf{P}^2 = \mathbf{P} = \mathbf{P}^{\mathrm{H}}$	Orthogonal projection matrix over $\mathbb{C}$
$\chi_{\mathbf{A}}(t),\ p_{\mathbf{A}}(t)$	Characteristic polynomial of $\mathbf{A}$, with $\chi_{\mathbf{A}}(t) = \det(t\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{A})$
$m_{\mathbf{A}}(t),\ \mu_{\mathbf{A}}(t)$	Minimal polynomial of $\mathbf{A}$
$\lambda,\ \lambda_i$	Eigenvalue of $\mathbf{A}$
$\mathbf{v},\ \mathbf{v}_i$	Eigenvector of $\mathbf{A}$
$E_\lambda(\mathbf{A}),\ V_\lambda(\mathbf{A})$	Eigenspace of $\mathbf{A}$ associated with λ
$\mathbf{J}_k(\lambda)$	Jordan block of size k with eigenvalue λ
$\sigma(\mathbf{A}),\ \operatorname{spec}(\mathbf{A})$	Spectrum of $\mathbf{A}$

Notation	Meaning
$\rho(\mathbf{A})$	Spectral radius
$\mathbf{A} \sim \mathbf{B}$	Similar square matrices
$\mathbf{P}_\lambda$	Spectral projection associated with the eigenvalue λ
$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{PDP}^{-1}$	Diagonalization of a diagonalizable matrix
$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{QDQ}^{\mathrm{T}}$	Orthogonal diagonalization of a real symmetric matrix
$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{UDU}^{\mathrm{H}}$	Unitary diagonalization of a complex normal matrix
$\mathbf{A} = \sum_{\lambda \in \sigma(\mathbf{A})} \lambda \mathbf{P}_\lambda$	Spectral decomposition of $\mathbf{A}$
$e^{\mathbf{A}},\ \exp(\mathbf{A})$	Matrix exponential
$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{LU}$	LU factorization, with $\mathbf{L}$ lower triangular and $\mathbf{U}$ upper triangular
$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{QR}$	QR factorization
$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{U\Sigma V}^{\mathrm{H}}$	Singular value decomposition (SVD) of $\mathbf{A}$
$\sigma_i(\mathbf{A})$	ith singular value of $\mathbf{A}$
$\mathbf{A}^\dagger$	Moore–Penrose pseudoinverse of $\mathbf{A}$
$\mathbf{A} \succ 0$	Positive definite Hermitian matrix (real symmetric in the real case)
$\mathbf{A} \succeq 0$	Positive semidefinite Hermitian matrix
$\mathbf{A} \prec 0$	Negative definite Hermitian matrix
$\mathbf{A} \preceq 0$	Negative semidefinite Hermitian matrix
$\mathbf{A} \succeq \mathbf{B}$	Löwner order: $\mathbf{A} - \mathbf{B} \succeq 0$, for Hermitian matrices of the same size
$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{LL}^{\mathrm{H}}$	Cholesky factorization of a positive definite Hermitian matrix

6 Differential Equations

Notation	Meaning
y'	First derivative
y''	Second derivative
$\dot{x}$	First derivative of x with respect to time
$\ddot{x}$	Second derivative of x with respect to time
$F(t, y, y', \ldots, y^{(n)}) = 0$	General nth-order ordinary differential equation
$y^{(n)} = f(t, y, \ldots, y^{(n-1)})$	nth-order ordinary differential equation in normal form
$y(t_0) = y_0$	Initial condition for a scalar differential equation
$y' + p(t)y = g(t)$	Standard form of a first-order linear differential equation
$\mu(t)$	Integrating factor for a first-order linear differential equation
$M(x, y)\ \mathrm{d}x + N(x, y)\ \mathrm{d}y = 0$	Differential form of a first-order differential equation
M_x, M_y, N_x, N_y	Subscript notation for the corresponding partial derivatives
$L[y]$	Linear differential operator applied to y
$L[y] = \sum_{k=0}^{n} a_k(t) y^{(k)}$	General nth-order linear differential operator, with $a_n \not\equiv 0$
$L[y] = 0,\ L[y] = g$	Homogeneous and nonhomogeneous linear differential equations, respectively
$y_{\mathrm{h}},\ y_{\mathrm{c}}$	Homogeneous or complementary part of a solution
y_{p}	Particular solution
$c_1, c_2, \ldots$	Arbitrary constants in a general solution
$\sum_{k=0}^{n} a_k r^k = 0$	Characteristic equation for a constant-coefficient homogeneous linear differential equation
$r_1, \ldots, r_n$	Characteristic roots

Notation	Meaning
$W(y_1, \dots, y_n)(t)$	Wronskian of $y_1, \dots, y_n$
$y = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n (x - x_0)^n$	Power-series form about the ordinary point x_0
$y = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n (x - x_0)^{n+r}$	Frobenius-series form about a regular singular point x_0; r denotes an indicial exponent
$\mathbf{x}' = \mathbf{f}(t, \mathbf{x})$	General first-order system
$\mathbf{x}(t_0) = \mathbf{x}_0$	Initial condition for a first-order system
$\mathbf{x}' = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x} + \mathbf{g}(t)$, $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x} + \mathbf{g}(t)$	Linear first-order system in state-vector form
$\mathbf{x}' = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x})$	Autonomous first-order system
$\mathbf{x}_\mathrm{e}$	Equilibrium point of an autonomous system
$\mathbf{\Phi}(t)$	Fundamental matrix of a linear system
$\mathcal{L}\{f(t)\}(s),\ \mathcal{L}[f](s)$	One-sided Laplace transform of f
$\mathcal{L}^{-1}\{F(s)\}(t),\ \mathcal{L}^{-1}[F](t)$	Inverse Laplace transform of F
$(f * g)(t)$	One-sided convolution of f and g
$H(t-a),\ u(t-a)$	Heaviside or unit-step function shifted to $t = a$; its value at the jump is specified when relevant
$\delta(t),\ \delta(t-a)$	Dirac delta distribution, or unit impulse, centered at 0 or shifted to $t = a$
$u_x, u_t, u_{xx}, u_{xy}, u_{tt}, \dots$	Subscript notation for partial derivatives of a scalar function u
$\partial_\mathbf{n} u$	Normal derivative of u along the unit normal $\mathbf{n}$; outward on $\partial\Omega$ for boundary conditions
$u\vert_{\partial\Omega} = g$	Dirichlet boundary condition on $\partial\Omega$
$\partial_\mathbf{n} u\vert_{\partial\Omega} = g$	Neumann boundary condition on $\partial\Omega$
$\alpha u + \beta\, \partial_\mathbf{n} u = g$	Robin boundary condition on $\partial\Omega$
$a_n,\ b_n$	Fourier coefficients of a real $2L$-periodic function
a_n	$a_n = \frac{1}{L}\int_{-L}^{L} f(x) \cos\frac{n\pi x}{L}\, \mathrm{d}x$ for $n \geq 0$
b_n	$b_n = \frac{1}{L}\int_{-L}^{L} f(x) \sin\frac{n\pi x}{L}\, \mathrm{d}x$ for $n \geq 1$
$\widehat{f}(\boldsymbol{\xi}),\ \mathcal{F}f(\boldsymbol{\xi})$	Fourier transform: $\widehat{f}(\boldsymbol{\xi}) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(\mathbf{x}) e^{-2\pi i \mathbf{x}\cdot\boldsymbol{\xi}}\, \mathrm{d}\mathbf{x}$
$\mathcal{F}^{-1}$	Inverse Fourier transform under the stated normalization
$-(py')' + qy = \lambda w y$	Sturm–Liouville eigenvalue equation, where p, q, and w are functions of x
$\lambda_n,\ \phi_n$	Sturm–Liouville eigenvalue and corresponding eigenfunction
$\langle f, g\rangle_w$	Weighted inner product, $\langle f, g\rangle_w \coloneqq \int_a^b \overline{f(x)} g(x) w(x)\, \mathrm{d}x$
$\langle \phi_m, \phi_n\rangle_w = \delta_{mn}$	Weighted orthonormality of eigenfunctions
$G(x, \xi),\ G(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\xi})$	Green's function
$\mathrm{Ai}(x),\ \mathrm{Bi}(x)$	Airy functions
$J_\nu(x)$	Bessel function of the first kind of order ν
$Y_\nu(x),\ N_\nu(x)$	Bessel function of the second kind of order ν
$I_\nu(x),\ K_\nu(x)$	Modified Bessel functions of the first and second kinds
$H_\nu^{(1)}(x),\ H_\nu^{(2)}(x)$	Hankel functions of the first and second kinds
$P_n(x)$	Legendre polynomial of degree n
$P_\nu(x),\ Q_\nu(x)$	Legendre functions of the first and second kinds
$P_\ell^m(x)$	Associated Legendre function for integer degree ℓ and order m

Notation	Meaning
$H_n(x),\ \mathrm{He}_n(x)$	Physicists' and probabilists' Hermite polynomials, respectively
$L_n^{(\alpha)}(x),\ L_n(x)$	Generalized and ordinary Laguerre polynomials
$T_n(x),\ U_n(x)$	Chebyshev polynomials of the first and second kinds
$P_n^{(\alpha,\beta)}(x)$	Jacobi polynomial
$C_n^{(\lambda)}(x)$	Gegenbauer (ultraspherical) polynomial
$\mathrm{erf}(x),\ \mathrm{erfc}(x)$	Error function and complementary error function
${}_2F_1(a,b;c;z)$	Gauss hypergeometric function

7 Numerical Analysis

Notation	Meaning
$\mathrm{fl}(x)$	Floating-point representation of x
u	Unit roundoff
$\varepsilon_{\text{mach}}$	Machine epsilon (floating-point spacing above 1)
$\mathrm{ulp}(x)$	Unit in the last place at x
δ	Relative rounding error in the standard floating-point model
$\hat{x},\ \hat{\mathbf{x}}$	Computed approximation to a scalar or vector
x^*	Exact solution or target of an iteration
$e_{\text{abs}} = \lvert\hat{x} - x\rvert$	Absolute error
$e_{\text{rel}} = \dfrac{\lvert\hat{x} - x\rvert}{\lvert x\rvert}$	Relative error, for $x \neq 0$
$\kappa(\mathbf{A})$	Condition number of $\mathbf{A}$ in the chosen norm
$\kappa_f(x)$	Relative condition number of f at x
$x_k,\ x^{(k)}$	kth iterate of a numerical method
$e_k = x_k - x^*$	Error of the kth iterate relative to x^*
$\mathbf{r}_k = \mathbf{b} - \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}_k$	Residual of the kth approximation to $\mathbf{A}\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$
$x_{k+1} = g(x_k)$	Fixed-point iteration
$x_{k+1} = x_k - \dfrac{f(x_k)}{f'(x_k)}$	Newton iteration for $f(x) = 0$
$x_i,\ f_i = f(x_i)$	Interpolation nodes and their function values
$P_n(x),\ p_n(x)$	Interpolating polynomial of degree at most n through $n+1$ distinct nodes
$\ell_i(x)$	Lagrange basis polynomial associated with node x_i
$f[x_0, \ldots, x_n]$	Divided difference of f at the nodes $x_0, \ldots, x_n$
h	Step size
$\Delta f_i = f_{i+1} - f_i$	Forward difference
$\nabla f_i = f_i - f_{i-1}$	Backward difference
$\sum_{i=0}^{n} w_i f(x_i)$	Quadrature rule with nodes x_i and weights w_i
$t_n = t_0 + nh$	Uniform grid with step size h
$h_n = t_{n+1} - t_n$	Variable step size
$y_n \approx y(t_n)$	Numerical approximation to $y(t_n)$
$e_n = y_n - y(t_n)$	Global error at the nth time step
τ_n	Local truncation error at the nth step
$y_{n+1} = y_n + hf(t_n, y_n)$	Forward (explicit) Euler method for $y' = f(t, y)$

8 Combinatorics and Discrete Mathematics

Notation	Meaning
$[n] = \{1, 2, \ldots, n\}$	Standard n-element set; $[0] = \varnothing$ when needed
$n!$	Factorial
$n!!$	Double factorial: product of positive integers of the same parity not exceeding n, with $0!! = (-1)!! = 1$
$n^{\underline{k}}$	Falling factorial, $n(n-1)\cdots(n-k+1)$
$n^{\overline{k}}$	Rising factorial, $n(n+1)\cdots(n+k-1)$
$(a)_k$	Rising Pochhammer symbol $a(a+1)\cdots(a+k-1)$ in special-functions contexts
${}_nP_r$	Number of ordered selections of r distinct elements from an n-element set, ${}_nP_r = \dfrac{n!}{(n-r)!}$ for $0 \le r \le n$
$\binom{n}{r}$, ${}_nC_r$	Number of r-element subsets of an n-element set
$\left(\!\binom{n}{r}\!\right)$, ${}_nH_r$	r-combinations with repetition from n types; equals $\binom{n+r-1}{r}$
$\binom{n}{n_1, \ldots, n_k}$	Multinomial coefficient, for nonnegative integers $n_1, \ldots, n_k$ with $n_1 + \cdots + n_k = n$
$\left[\begin{smallmatrix} n \\ k \end{smallmatrix}\right]$, $c(n,k)$	Unsigned Stirling number of the first kind; permutations of n elements with k cycles
$(-1)^{n-k}\left[\begin{smallmatrix} n \\ k \end{smallmatrix}\right]$, $s(n,k)$	Signed Stirling number of the first kind; $s(n,k) = (-1)^{n-k}c(n,k)$
$\left\{\begin{smallmatrix} n \\ k \end{smallmatrix}\right\}$, $S(n,k)$	Stirling number of the second kind; partitions of an n-element set into k nonempty blocks
D_n, $!n$	Number of derangements of n elements; permutations with no fixed points
C_n	nth Catalan number, $C_n = \dfrac{1}{n+1}\binom{2n}{n}$ for $n \ge 0$
B_n	nth Bell number; number of partitions of an n-element set
$p(n)$	Number of integer partitions of n, with $p(0) = 1$
$H_n = \sum_{k=1}^{n} \dfrac{1}{k}$	nth harmonic number for $n \ge 1$, with $H_0 = 0$
$(X, \preceq)$	Partially ordered set (poset)
$\prec$, $\succeq$, $\succ$	Strict and reverse order relations associated with $\preceq$
$\le_{\text{lex}}$	Lexicographic order
$x \lessdot y$	Cover relation: y covers x
B_n, $2^{[n]}$	Boolean lattice of subsets of $[n]$, ordered by inclusion
$G = (V, E)$	Graph with vertex set V and edge set E; simple and undirected unless stated otherwise
$V(G)$	Vertex set of G
$E(G)$	Edge set of G
$N(v)$, $\Gamma(v)$	Neighborhood of vertex v
$N[v] = N(v) \cup \{v\}$	Closed neighborhood of the vertex v
$\deg_G(v)$, $\deg(v)$	Degree of vertex v
$\deg^+(v)$, $\deg^-(v)$	Out-degree and in-degree of v in a directed graph
$\delta(G)$, $\Delta(G)$	Minimum and maximum vertex degrees, respectively, of a nonempty finite graph G
$d_G(u,v)$, $d(u,v)$	Graph distance between vertices u and v

Notation	Meaning
$G[S]$	Subgraph of G induced by the vertex set $S \subseteq V(G)$
$G - v,\ G - S$	Graph obtained by deleting the vertex v, or all vertices in S, together with their incident edges
$G - e$	Graph obtained by deleting the edge e
G/e	Graph obtained by contracting the edge e
$\overline{G}$	Complement of the graph G
K_n	Complete graph on n vertices
$K_{m,n}$	Complete bipartite graph with parts of sizes m and n
P_n	Path graph on n vertices
C_n	Cycle graph on n vertices
$\mathbf{A}(G),\ \mathbf{A}_G$	Adjacency matrix of G
$\mathbf{D}(G),\ \mathbf{D}_G$	Degree matrix of G, the diagonal matrix of vertex degrees in the chosen vertex order
$\mathbf{L}(G),\ \mathbf{L}_G$	Graph Laplacian, usually $\mathbf{D}(G) - \mathbf{A}(G)$
$\chi(G)$	Chromatic number of G
$P_G(k)$	Chromatic polynomial of G, counting proper colorings with k labeled colors
$\nu(G)$	Matching number of G: the maximum size of a matching (a set of pairwise vertex-disjoint edges)
$\alpha(G)$	Independence number of G: maximum size of an independent vertex set
$\omega(G)$	Clique number of G: maximum size of a complete vertex set
$\mathrm{Aut}(G)$	Automorphism group of the graph G
$\tau(G),\ T(G)$	Number of spanning trees of G
$R(k,\ell),\ r(k,\ell),\ R(k),\ r(k)$	Ramsey numbers; $R(k) = R(k,k)$ in the diagonal case
$A(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n$	Ordinary generating function of the sequence $(a_n)_{n\geq 0}$
$\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n \frac{x^n}{n!}$	Exponential generating function of the sequence $(a_n)_{n\geq 0}$
$[x^n]F(x)$	Coefficient of x^n in the formal power series or generating function $F(x)$

9 Probability and Statistics

Notation	Meaning
$(\Omega, \mathcal{F}, \mathbb{P})$	Probability space, with sample space Ω, event σ-algebra $\mathcal{F}$, and probability measure $\mathbb{P}$
$\omega \in \Omega$	Outcome or sample point
$A \in \mathcal{F}$	Event
$X : \Omega \to \mathbb{R}$	Real-valued random variable on Ω
$\mathbb{P}(A)$	Probability of event A
$\mathbb{P}(A \mid B)$	Conditional probability of A given B
$X \perp\!\!\!\perp Y$	X and Y are independent.
$X \perp\!\!\!\perp Y \mid Z$	X and Y are conditionally independent given Z.
$p_X(x) = \mathbb{P}(X = x)$	Probability mass function (pmf) of a discrete random variable X
$f_X(x)$	Probability density function (pdf) of X
$F_X(x) = \mathbb{P}(X \leq x)$	Cumulative distribution function (cdf) of X

Notation	Meaning
$p_{X,Y}(x,y),\ f_{X,Y}(x,y)$	Joint pmf or joint pdf of (X,Y)
$p_{X\mid Y}(x\mid y),\ f_{X\mid Y}(x\mid y)$	Conditional pmf or conditional pdf of X given $Y=y$
$F^{-1}(p)$	Generalized inverse of the cdf F: $\inf\{x\in\mathbb{R}\mid F(x)\geq p\}$ for $0<p<1$
$\mathcal{L}(X)$	Distribution (law) of the random variable X
$X\overset{\mathrm{d}}{=}Y$	Equality in distribution of the random variables X and Y
$X\sim\mathrm{Bern}(p)$	Bernoulli distribution with success probability p
$X\sim\mathrm{Bin}(n,p)$	Binomial distribution
$X\sim\mathrm{Hypergeom}(N,K,n)$	Hypergeometric distribution: number of successes in n draws without replacement from N items, K of which are successes
$X\sim\mathrm{Geom}(p)$	Geometric distribution on $\mathbb{N}$, counting trials through the first success
$X\sim\mathrm{Pois}(\lambda)$	Poisson distribution with parameter λ
$X\sim\mathrm{Unif}(a,b)$	Continuous uniform distribution on $[a,b]$
$X\sim\mathrm{Exp}(\lambda)$	Exponential distribution with rate λ
$X\sim\Gamma(\alpha,\beta)$	Gamma distribution with shape α and rate β
$X\sim\Gamma(\alpha,\theta)$	Gamma distribution with shape α and scale $\theta=1/\beta$
$X\sim\mathrm{Beta}(\alpha,\beta)$	Beta distribution with shape parameters α and β
$X\sim\mathcal{N}(\mu,\sigma^2)$, $X\sim N(\mu,\sigma^2)$	Normal distribution with mean μ and variance σ^2
$\phi(x)$	Standard normal probability density function
$\Phi(x)$	Standard normal cumulative distribution function
$X\sim\chi^2_\nu$	Chi-squared distribution with ν degrees of freedom
$X\sim t_\nu$	Student's t distribution with ν degrees of freedom
$X\sim F_{\nu_1,\nu_2}$	F distribution with numerator and denominator degrees of freedom ν_1,ν_2
$\mathbb{E}[X]$	Expectation of random variable X
$\mathbb{E}[X\mid Y]$	Conditional expectation of X given Y
$\mathbb{E}[X\mid\mathcal{G}]$	Conditional expectation of X with respect to a sub-σ-algebra $\mathcal{G}\subseteq\mathcal{F}$
$\mathrm{Var}(X)$	Variance of X
$\sigma_X=\sqrt{\mathrm{Var}(X)}$	Population standard deviation of X
$\mathrm{Cov}(X,Y)$	Covariance of X and Y
$\mathbf{\Sigma}=\mathrm{Cov}(\mathbf{X})$	Covariance matrix of the random vector $\mathbf{X}$
$\rho_{X,Y},\ \mathrm{Corr}(X,Y)$	Pearson correlation coefficient of X and Y
r	Sample correlation coefficient
$\varphi_X(t)=\mathbb{E}[e^{itX}]$	Characteristic function of X
$M_X(t)=\mathbb{E}[e^{tX}]$	Moment-generating function (mgf) of X
$\bar{X}=\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^{n}X_i$	Sample mean as a statistic of a random sample $X_1,\dots,X_n$
$\bar{x}=\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^{n}x_i$	Observed sample mean for data $x_1,\dots,x_n$
$S^2=\frac{1}{n-1}\sum_{i=1}^{n}(X_i-\bar{X})^2$	Sample variance as a statistic, for $n\geq 2$
$s^2=\frac{1}{n-1}\sum_{i=1}^{n}(x_i-\bar{x})^2$	Observed sample variance, for $n\geq 2$
$S=\sqrt{S^2},\ s=\sqrt{s^2}$	Sample standard deviation as a statistic and its observed value
$\hat{\theta}$	Estimator or estimate of a parameter θ
$\mathrm{Bias}(\hat{\theta})$	Bias of the estimator $\hat{\theta}$ for θ

Notation	Meaning
$\mathrm{MSE}(\hat{\theta})$	Mean squared error of the estimator $\hat{\theta}$
$\hat{p}$	Estimator or estimate of a probability parameter p; commonly the sample proportion
$\mathrm{SE}(\hat{\theta})$	Standard error of an estimator $\hat{\theta}$
$L(\theta;\mathbf{x})$	Likelihood function for parameter θ given observed data $\mathbf{x}$
$\ell(\theta;\mathbf{x}) = \ln L(\theta;\mathbf{x})$	Log-likelihood function
H_0	Null hypothesis
$H_1,\ H_a$	Alternative hypothesis
α	Significance level of a hypothesis test
β	Type II error probability of a hypothesis test
ν	Degrees of freedom
$X_n \xrightarrow{\text{a.s.}} X$	Almost-sure convergence
$X_n \xrightarrow{\mathbb{P}} X$	Convergence in probability
$X_n \xrightarrow{L^p} X$	Convergence in L^p
$X_n \xrightarrow{\text{d}} X,\ X_n \Rightarrow X$	Convergence in distribution

10 Geometry

In triangle notation, a, b, c denote the side lengths opposite vertices A, B, C, respectively. In differential geometry, uppercase italic letters such as X, Y may denote vector fields.

Notation	Meaning
$\triangle ABC$	Triangle with vertices A, B, C
$\angle ABC$	Geometric angle with vertex B
$m\angle ABC$	Measure of the angle $\angle ABC$
$\angle(\ell, m)$	Directed angle from the line ℓ to the line m, taken modulo π
$\overline{AB}$	Segment joining A and B
AB	Length of $\overline{AB}$
$\overrightarrow{AB}$	Ray from A through B, or vector from A to B, according to context
$\overrightarrow{AB} = \mathbf{b} - \mathbf{a}$	Vector from A to B when $\mathbf{a}$ and $\mathbf{b}$ are the corresponding position vectors
$\overleftrightarrow{AB}$	Line through A and B
$\ell \parallel m$	Lines ℓ and m are parallel
$\ell \perp m$	Lines ℓ and m are perpendicular
$\triangle ABC \cong \triangle DEF$	Congruent triangles; corresponding vertices are listed in the same order
$\triangle ABC \sim \triangle DEF$	Similar triangles; corresponding vertices are listed in the same order
$[ABC]$	Area of $\triangle ABC$
$C(O, r)$	Circle with center O and radius r
$\odot O$	Circle centered at O
$\mathrm{Pow}_\omega(P)$	Power of P with respect to the circle ω
(ABC)	Circle through the noncollinear points A, B, C; in particular, the circumcircle of $\triangle ABC$
$\widehat{AB},\ \widehat{ACB}$	Arcs specified by their endpoints, with an additional point used when needed to distinguish the intended arc
O, I, H, G	Circumcenter, incenter, orthocenter, and centroid of a triangle, respectively
R, r	Circumradius and inradius of a triangle, respectively

Notation	Meaning
$s = \dfrac{a+b+c}{2}$	Semiperimeter of a triangle with side lengths a, b, c
$d(P, Q)$	Distance between the points P and Q
$\operatorname{dist}(P, A)$	Distance from the point P to the set A
$\operatorname{length}(C),\ \ell(C)$	Length of the curve C
$\operatorname{area}(S)$	Area of the surface S
$\operatorname{vol}(\Omega)$	Volume of the region Ω
$\operatorname{diam}(A)$	Diameter of the set A
$\operatorname{conv}(A)$	Convex hull of the set A
$\operatorname{aff}(A)$	Affine hull of the set A
$\mathbb{R}^n$	n-dimensional real Euclidean space
$\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{p} + t\mathbf{v}$	Parametric equation of a line through $\mathbf{p}$ in the direction $\mathbf{v}$
$\mathbf{n} \cdot (\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{p}) = 0$	Hyperplane through $\mathbf{p}$ with normal vector $\mathbf{n}$
$S^n = \{\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^{n+1} \mid \lVert\mathbf{x}\rVert = 1\}$	Unit n-sphere
$S_r^{n-1}(\mathbf{a})$	Sphere of radius r centered at $\mathbf{a} \in \mathbb{R}^n$
$\operatorname{Isom}(X)$	Isometry group of the metric or geometric space X
$\mathbb{RP}^n$	Real projective n-space
$\mathbb{CP}^n$	Complex projective n-space
$[x_0 : \cdots : x_n]$	Homogeneous coordinates in projective space
$\mathbb{H}^n$	n-dimensional hyperbolic space
$d_{\mathbb{H}}$	Hyperbolic distance
$\gamma \colon I \to \mathbb{R}^n$	Parametrized curve in $\mathbb{R}^n$
$\dot{\gamma}(t)$	Velocity (tangent) vector of γ at t
s	Arc-length parameter
$\mathbf{T},\ \mathbf{N},\ \mathbf{B}$	Unit tangent, principal normal, and binormal vectors of the Frenet frame
κ	Curvature of a regular curve
τ	Torsion of a space curve
T_pM	Tangent space of the manifold or regular surface M at p
$\mathbf{n} \colon M \to S^2$	Gauss map of an oriented surface $M \subseteq \mathbb{R}^3$, assigning its unit normal vector
$\mathrm{I},\ \mathrm{II}$	First and second fundamental forms of a regular surface
$\kappa_1,\ \kappa_2$	Principal curvatures of a regular surface
$K = \kappa_1\kappa_2$	Gaussian curvature of a regular surface
$H = \dfrac{\kappa_1 + \kappa_2}{2}$	Mean curvature of a regular surface under the average convention
(M, g)	Riemannian manifold M with Riemannian metric g
g_p	Riemannian inner product on T_pM
$d_g(p, q)$	Riemannian distance between p and q under metric g
$\nabla_X Y$	Covariant derivative of Y along X
Γ_{ij}^k	Christoffel symbols of a connection in local coordinates
$\exp_p \colon \mathcal{D}_p \to M$	Riemannian exponential map at p with domain $\mathcal{D}_p$
$\nabla_{\dot{\gamma}}\dot{\gamma} = 0$	Geodesic equation for an affinely parametrized curve γ

11 Number Theory

Notation	Meaning
$a \mid b$	a divides b.
$a \nmid b$	a does not divide b.
$\gcd(a_1, \ldots, a_n),\ (a, b)$	Greatest common divisor; (a, b) for two integers when the context is clear
$\operatorname{lcm}(a_1, \ldots, a_n)$	Least common multiple
$p^k \parallel n$	p^k exactly divides n: $p^k \mid n$ and $p^{k+1} \nmid n$.
$v_p(n),\ \nu_p(n)$	p-adic valuation of n
$a \equiv b \pmod{n}$	a is congruent to b modulo n.
$[a]_n,\ \overline{a}$	Residue class of a modulo n; $\overline{a}$ when the modulus is clear
$a \bmod n$	Least nonnegative remainder of a modulo n, for $n > 0$
$\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$	Ring of residue classes modulo n
$(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$	Multiplicative group of units modulo n
$a^{-1} \pmod{n}$	Multiplicative inverse of a modulo n, for $\gcd(a, n) = 1$
$\operatorname{ord}_n(a)$	Multiplicative order of a modulo n, for $\gcd(a, n) = 1$
$\mathbb{F}_q,\ \mathrm{GF}(q)$	Finite field with q elements, where q is a prime power
$\left(\frac{a}{p}\right)$	Legendre symbol, for an odd prime p
$\left(\frac{a}{n}\right)$	Jacobi symbol, for an odd positive integer n
$\chi \pmod{q}$	Dirichlet character modulo q
$L(s, \chi)$	Dirichlet L-function associated with χ
$\varphi(n)$	Euler totient function
$\lambda(n)$	Carmichael function of n
B_n	nth Bernoulli number, under the convention $B_1 = -\frac{1}{2}$
$\sum_{d \mid n}$	Sum over the positive divisors d of n
$\prod_{p \mid n}$	Product over the prime divisors p of n
$\sigma_k(n) = \sum_{d \mid n} d^k$	Sum of the kth powers of the positive divisors of n
$\tau(n) = \sigma_0(n),\ d(n)$	Number of positive divisors of n
$\sigma(n) = \sigma_1(n)$	Sum of positive divisors of n
$\mu(n)$	Möbius function
$\omega(n)$	Number of distinct prime divisors of n
$\Omega(n)$	Number of prime factors of n, counted with multiplicity
$\operatorname{rad}(n)$	Product of the distinct prime divisors of n
$(f * g)(n) = \sum_{d \mid n} f(d) g(n/d)$	Dirichlet convolution of arithmetic functions f and g
$\pi(x)$	Number of primes not exceeding x
$\Lambda(n)$	Von Mangoldt function
$[a_0; a_1, a_2, \ldots]$	Simple continued fraction
$[a_0; a_1, \ldots, a_n] = \frac{p_n}{q_n}$	nth convergent of a continued fraction
$\Phi_n(x)$	nth cyclotomic polynomial
$\mathbb{Z}[i]$	Ring of Gaussian integers
$K = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{d})$	Quadratic field, with squarefree $d \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $d \neq 1$
$\mathcal{O}_K$	Ring of integers of the number field K
$\mathrm{N}(\mathfrak{a}) = \lvert\mathcal{O}_K/\mathfrak{a}\rvert$	Absolute norm of a nonzero integral ideal $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathcal{O}_K$

Notation	Meaning
$D_K,\ \mathrm{disc}(K)$	Discriminant of the number field K
$\mathrm{Cl}(K)$	Ideal class group of the number field K
$h_K = \lvert\mathrm{Cl}(K)\rvert$	Class number of the number field K

12 Algebra

Unless otherwise stated, rings are associative and have an identity (the zero ring is allowed), but need not be commutative. Subrings contain the identity of the ambient ring, ring homomorphisms preserve identities, ideals are two-sided, and modules are unital left modules.

Notation	Meaning
G	Group
$e,\ 1_G$	Identity element of a group
$0_G,\ -g$	Identity and inverse notation for an additively written group G
g^{-1}	Inverse of $g \in G$
$\lvert G\rvert$	Order (cardinality) of G
$\mathrm{ord}(g),\ \lvert g\rvert$	Order of the element g
$\langle S\rangle$	Subgroup generated by $S \subseteq G$
$\langle g\rangle$	Cyclic subgroup generated by g
$H \leq G$	H is a subgroup of G.
$H \trianglelefteq G$	H is a normal subgroup of G.
$gH,\ Hg$	Left and right cosets of H in G
$[G : H]$	Index of H in G
G/H	Set of left cosets of $H \leq G$ in G; a quotient group when $H \trianglelefteq G$
$\ker\varphi$	Kernel of the homomorphism φ
$\mathrm{im}\,\varphi$	Image of the homomorphism φ
$\mathrm{Hom}(G, H)$	Set of group homomorphisms from G to H
$\mathrm{Aut}(G)$	Automorphism group of G
$\mathrm{Inn}(G)$	Inner automorphism group of G
$\mathrm{Out}(G)$	Outer automorphism group $\mathrm{Aut}(G)/\mathrm{Inn}(G)$
$Z(G)$	Center of G
$C_G(A),\ C_G(x)$	Centralizer in G of $A \subseteq G$ or $x \in G$
$N_G(A),\ N_G(H)$	Normalizer in G of $A \subseteq G$ or $H \leq G$
$g^G = \{hgh^{-1} \mid h \in G\}$	Conjugacy class of $g \in G$
$[x, y] \coloneqq x^{-1}y^{-1}xy$	Commutator of x and y
$[G, G],\ G'$	Commutator (derived) subgroup of G
$G^{\mathrm{ab}} = G/[G, G]$	Abelianization of G
$\mathrm{Syl}_p(G)$	Set of Sylow p-subgroups of G
n_p	Number of Sylow p-subgroups of G
$G \curvearrowright X$	Action of G on X
$g \cdot x$	Action of $g \in G$ on $x \in X$
$G \cdot x,\ \mathrm{Orb}_G(x),\ \mathrm{Orb}(x)$	Orbit of x under the action of G
$G\backslash X,\ X/G$	Set of orbits of a left G-action on X; X/G is also used when the action convention is clear
$\mathrm{Stab}_G(x),\ G_x$	Stabilizer of x in G
$\mathrm{Fix}(g),\ X^g$	Fixed-point set $\{x \in X \mid g \cdot x = x\}$ of $g \in G$ acting on X
X^H	Common fixed-point set $\{x \in X \mid h \cdot x = x \text{ for all } h \in H\}$ of $H \leq G$

Notation	Meaning
$G \times H$	Direct product of groups
$N \rtimes_\varphi H$	Semidirect product determined by $\varphi\colon H \to \mathrm{Aut}(N)$, with N the normal factor
$\langle S \mid R \rangle$	Group presentation with generators S and relations R
C_n	Cyclic group of order n
D_n	Dihedral group of symmetries of a regular n-gon; $\lvert D_n \rvert = 2n$ (alternative convention: D_{2n})
$\mathrm{Sym}(X)$	Symmetric group of all permutations of the set X
$S_n,\ \mathfrak{S}_n$	Symmetric group on n symbols
$(\sigma\tau)(x) = \sigma(\tau(x))$	Composition of permutations, applying the rightmost first
$(a_1\, a_2\, \ldots\, a_k)$	Cycle notation for a permutation sending a_i to a_{i+1} for $i < k$ and a_k to a_1
$A_n,\ \mathfrak{A}_n$	Alternating group on n symbols
V_4	Klein four-group
Q_8	Quaternion group of order 8
$\mathrm{GL}_n(F)$	General linear group over F
$\mathrm{SL}_n(F)$	Special linear group over F
$\mathrm{O}(n)$	Orthogonal group of $n \times n$ real matrices
$\mathrm{SO}(n)$	Special orthogonal group; matrices in $\mathrm{O}(n)$ with determinant 1
$\mathrm{U}(n)$	Unitary group of $n \times n$ complex matrices
$\mathrm{SU}(n)$	Special unitary group; matrices in $\mathrm{U}(n)$ with determinant 1
R	Ring
$0_R,\ 1_R$	Additive and multiplicative identities of R
$R^\times$	Group of units of R
$I,\ J,\ \mathfrak{a},\ \mathfrak{b}$	Ideals of R
$\mathfrak{p},\ \mathfrak{q}$	Prime ideals
$\mathfrak{m},\ \mathfrak{n}$	Maximal ideals
$\mathrm{Spec}(R)$	Prime spectrum of the commutative ring R
$\sqrt{I}$	Radical of the ideal I in a commutative ring
(a)	Two-sided ideal generated by a; in a commutative ring, the usual principal ideal
$(a_1, \ldots, a_n)$	Two-sided ideal generated by $a_1, \ldots, a_n$
$I + J$	Sum of the ideals I and J
IJ	Product of the ideals I and J
R/I	Quotient ring
$R[x],\ R[x_1, \ldots, x_n]$	Polynomial rings over R in commuting central indeterminates
$R[\alpha]$	Subring generated by R and α in a commutative R-algebra
$\deg f$	Degree of the polynomial f
$\mathrm{disc}(f)$	Discriminant of the polynomial f
$M_n(R)$	Ring of $n \times n$ matrices over R
$R[G]$	Group ring of G over R
$\mathrm{Frac}(R)$	Fraction field of the integral domain R
$S^{-1}R$	Localization of a commutative ring R at a multiplicatively closed subset $S \subseteq R$
$R_\mathfrak{p}$	Localization of a commutative ring R at a prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$: $(R \setminus \mathfrak{p})^{-1}R$
$\mathrm{char}\, R$	Characteristic of R
$\mathbb{H}$	Quaternion division algebra over $\mathbb{R}$
$M,\ N$	Left R-modules, unless otherwise stated

Notation	Meaning
${}_RM,\ M_R$	Left and right R-modules, when the side is emphasized
M/N	Quotient module, for a submodule N of M
$M \oplus N$	Direct sum of modules
$\bigoplus_{i\in\Lambda} M_i$	Direct sum of an indexed family of modules, with index set Λ
R^n	Free R-module of rank n
$\mathrm{Hom}_R(M,N)$	Set of R-module homomorphisms from M to N
$\mathrm{End}_R(M)$	Endomorphism ring of the R-module M
$\mathrm{Aut}_R(M)$	Automorphism group of the R-module M
$\mathrm{Ann}_R(M)$	Annihilator of the R-module M
$M_R \otimes_R {}_RN,\ M \otimes_R N$	Tensor product of a right R-module M and a left R-module N
K/F	Field extension of F by K
$[K:F]$	Degree of the field extension K/F
$F(\alpha),\ F(\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_n)$	Fields generated over F by the indicated elements
$F[\alpha]$	Subring (equivalently, F-subalgebra) generated by F and α
$m_{\alpha,F}(x)$	Minimal polynomial of α over F
$\overline{F}$	Algebraic closure of F
$\mathrm{Gal}(L/K)$	Galois group of L/K
L^H	Fixed field of $H \leq \mathrm{Gal}(L/K)$
$\mathrm{Tr}_{L/K}(\alpha)$	Field trace of $\alpha \in L$ from L to K
$\mathrm{N}_{L/K}(\alpha)$	Field norm of $\alpha \in L$ from L to K
$\mathrm{trdeg}_K L$	Transcendence degree of L over K

13 Topology

Notation	Meaning
$(X,\mathcal{T})$	Topological space X with topology $\mathcal{T}$
$\mathcal{T}$	Topology on the underlying set X
$\mathcal{B}$	Basis for a topology
$\mathcal{S}$	Subbasis for a topology
$A^\circ,\ \mathrm{int}\, A$	Interior of A
$\overline{A},\ \mathrm{cl}\, A$	Closure of A
∂A	Boundary of A
$\mathrm{ext}\, A$	Exterior of A in X
A'	Derived set of A (its accumulation points)
T_0, T_1, T_2, T_3, T_4	Separation axioms, with T_3 including regularity and T_1, and T_4 including normality and T_1
(X,d)	Metric space X with metric d
$\mathcal{T}_A = \{A \cap U \mid U \in \mathcal{T}\}$	Subspace topology on $A \subseteq X$
$\pi_i \colon \prod_{j\in J} X_j \to X_i$	Coordinate projection of a product space, for $i \in J$
$X/\!\sim$	Quotient space when the quotient set is equipped with the quotient topology
$q \colon X \twoheadrightarrow X/\!\sim$	Canonical quotient map
X/A	Quotient space obtained by collapsing the subspace $A \subseteq X$ to a point
$C(X,Y)$	Set of continuous maps from X to Y

Notation	Meaning
$X \cong Y$	Homeomorphic spaces
$\mathrm{Homeo}(X)$	Group of self-homeomorphisms of X
$\iota\colon A \hookrightarrow X$	Inclusion map of a subspace $A \subseteq X$
$f\colon X \hookrightarrow Y$	Topological embedding when explicitly stated; the hook arrow by itself retains its general meaning of injectivity
(X, x_0)	Pointed space with basepoint x_0
$I = [0, 1]$	Unit interval, especially for paths and homotopies
$D^n = \{\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n \mid \|\mathbf{x}\| \leq 1\}$	Closed n-disk
$X \vee Y$	Wedge sum of pointed spaces X and Y
$\gamma\colon I \to X$	Path in X
$\gamma(0) = \gamma(1) = x_0$	Loop based at x_0
$H\colon X \times I \to Y$	Homotopy between maps $X \to Y$
$f \simeq g$	Homotopic maps $f, g\colon X \to Y$
$X \simeq Y$	Homotopy equivalent spaces
$[\gamma]$	Homotopy class of a path or loop γ, according to context
$\pi_0(X)$	Set of path-connected components of X; not generally a group
$\pi_1(X, x_0)$	Fundamental group of X based at x_0
$\pi_n(X, x_0)$	nth homotopy group of the pointed space (X, x_0), for $n \geq 1$
f_*	Induced covariant map associated with f
f^*	Induced contravariant map associated with f
$p\colon \widetilde{X} \to X$	Covering map, with $\widetilde{X}$ a covering space of X
$\widetilde{X}$	Covering space of X; universal cover when specified
$\mathrm{Deck}(p)$	Group of deck transformations of the covering p
M^n	n-dimensional topological manifold; Hausdorff, second-countable, and without boundary unless stated otherwise
∂M	Intrinsic boundary of a manifold with boundary M
Σ_g	Closed connected orientable surface of genus g
$M \# N$	Connected sum of manifolds M and N
$\chi(X)$	Euler characteristic of X
$H_n(X; G)$	nth homology group of X with coefficients in G
$H_n(X, A; G)$	nth relative homology group of a pair (X, A) with coefficients in an abelian group G, where $A \subseteq X$
$H_n(X)$	Integral homology group $H_n(X; \mathbb{Z})$ when coefficients are omitted
$\widetilde{H}_n(X; G)$	nth reduced homology group of X with coefficients in G
$H^n(X; G)$	nth cohomology group of X with coefficients in G
$b_n(X)$	nth Betti number of X

14 Miscellaneous Notation

Notation	Meaning
$\lfloor x \rfloor$	Floor of x
$\lceil x \rceil$	Ceiling of x
$\{x\}$	Fractional part $x - \lfloor x \rfloor$, when unambiguous
$\mathrm{sgn}(x)$	Sign of a real number or permutation, according to context
$a \propto b$	a is proportional to b; in a functional context, the proportionality factor is independent of the variable under discussion.

Notation	Meaning
$O(g(n))$	Big-O upper asymptotic bound
$o(g(n))$	Little-o strict asymptotic bound
$\Theta(g(n))$	Two-sided asymptotic order
$\Omega(g(n))$	Asymptotic lower bound
$f \lesssim g,\ f \gtrsim g$	Upper and lower bounds up to a positive constant factor, respectively
$f(x) \asymp g(x)$	Two-sided asymptotic bounds up to positive constant factors
$\sum_{\text{cyc}} f(a,b,c)$	Cyclic sum over a, b, c
$\sum_{\text{sym}} f(a,b,c)$	Symmetric sum over all permutations of a, b, c
Δq	Finite change in a quantity q
δ_{ij}	Kronecker delta: 1 if $i = j$ and 0 otherwise
ϵ_{ijk}	Three-dimensional Levi–Civita symbol: the sign of the permutation (i, j, k) when (i, j, k) is a permutation of $(1, 2, 3)$, and 0 otherwise